

Slide Deck Standards.

How every lecture deck in this course is built, so they all feel like the same course. The intro deck is the reference; **slides-template.html** is the file you copy to start a new one. Nothing here needs a paid program. A deck is one HTML file in the repo, it opens as a scrollable page on a phone and as a full-screen presentation on the projector, and every deck gets the same clock, the same click-to-zoom boxes, and the same controls.

START HERE

Making a new deck, in five steps

1. Copy `slides-template.html` and save it as `slides-<topic>.html` in the repo root, for example `slides-cell-anatomy.html`. Lowercase, hyphens, no spaces.
2. Change the two **LECTURE TITLE** spots near the top (the browser tab title and the page header) and rewrite the title slide.
3. Build the deck by **copying whole slides** from the template: title, four boxes, two boxes with a number panel, rows with dots, activity, closing. Each `<section class="slide">` is one slide. Delete the ones you do not use.
4. Add the deck to **Course tools** or the week page like any other page, and give it a Faculty Hub tile if you will present from it.
5. Open it, click **Present**, and step through with the arrow key once before class. If anything reads stiff out loud, fix the words.

THE FEEL

Prezi, not PowerPoint

Students do not want a wall of bullets, and they should not have to read while you talk. So every content box starts **collapsed to its heading**. When you click it (or press the arrow), it **zooms out into a big panel** with one large keyword line, the words that matter in red, and the full sentence in small type underneath. The arrow key opens the next box, and only advances the slide when every box on it has been opened, so you can run a whole lecture from a clicker. Boxes you have opened get a small "opened" mark. Press **A** to mark every box on a slide as seen and skip ahead.

Slides with a QR code, a grade bar, or a reference list stay static on purpose. Everything else zooms.

ANATOMY OF A BOX

Heading, keyword line, sentence

Every box has the same three parts, in this order, and the zoom depends on it:

```
<div class="card">
  <h3>Short heading</h3>
  <p class="kw"><b>Key words</b> in red, rest plain.</p>
  <p>The full sentence, one or two lines, in plain language.</p>
</div>
```

The keyword line is what the room reads. Keep it under ten words. Bold only the two or three words that carry the idea; the bold is what turns red. Write it as a real phrase, not a fragment stack: "Pull it out of memory. Don't just reread." works; "Retrieve. Don't reread." does not. The full sentence is for the student reading later on their phone.

The same three parts work in a `.row` (number dot on the left) and a `.darkpanel` (navy box for a big statistic). Rows use `<div class="dot">1</div>` and a wrapping `<div>` for the text; the template shows the exact markup.

TITLES

Every title colors its key phrase

Wrap the two to four words that matter in `<span class="hl">...</span>`. It renders terra on white slides and gold on dark slides, automatically. One phrase per title, never the whole title. Titles are sentence case, not Title Case, and read like something you would say: "Your brain saves what it retrieves" rather than "Retrieval Practice Overview."

Above the title, the small caps **kicker** names the section in three or four words ("The method", "How memory actually works"). Below the boxes, the bold **bigline** is the one takeaway sentence, the line you would want them to remember if they remember nothing else. Use `class="bigline terra"` to make it terra when the slide needs a punch.

SLIDE TYPES

Six shapes cover almost everything

SLIDE	CLASS	USE IT FOR
Title	slide dark	Opening slide. Kicker, big title with a terra cotta phrase (<code>span.tc</code>), a warm two-sentence lede.
Four boxes	slide + grid4	Steps in a process, four ideas, four structures. Cards with a gold number (<code>p.n</code>).
Two boxes + number panel	slide + grid2	A claim beside its evidence. Right side is a <code>.darkpanel</code> with a big number.
Rows	slide + rows	Three or four points that need a little more room than a card. Number dots on the left.
Activity	slide paper	Anything students do. Off-white background, red Activity badge, time chip, and <code>data-timer="SECONDS"</code> so the clock preloads.
Closing	slide dark	What to do before next class, or the deal. Dark, short list, one big line.

COLORS AND TYPE

The palette, and where each color goes

TOKEN	HEX	USED FOR
 navy	#08101F	Dark slide background, body text on light slides, number dots
 terra	#8B1D1D	Key phrases on white, red keywords in boxes, activity badge, buttons
 terra cotta	#C9553A	Key phrase on the title slide only (it reads better than terra on navy)
 gold	#DCB45C	Kickers and key phrases on dark slides, big numbers on dark panels, progress bar. Never as text on white.
 teal	#2C5F66	Positive labels ("Actually builds memory"), grade bar third block
 muted	#3D4860	Small sentences under keyword lines on white; source lines
 light	#D9DEE8	All small text on dark backgrounds. Never muted on navy; it fails contrast.

Font: Plus Jakarta Sans for everything, including small caps kickers. Weights 400, 600, 700, 800. No italics anywhere. Cards are white with a soft shadow, 8px corners for cards, no accent bars or borders on the left edge.

WORDS

Write it the way you would say it

The audit rule for every line: **would a first-week student understand it on one read, and would you say it out loud that way?** If not, rewrite. Some patterns to catch, with fixes:

"Retrieval practice strengthens encoding."

"Pulling it out of your own head is what makes it stick."

"Verified study hours, the habits that predict success."

"You earn them with verified study hours, which really do predict success in this class."

"Private writing. No talking."

"Write on your own for now, no talking yet."

"Behaviors that caused damage."

"Things people did that hurt the team."

"Meta-analysis of 225 studies."

"They combined the results of 225 studies."

"Lowest academic quartile."

"The students who came in with the weakest grades."

Full sentences, warm and direct. Say "you" and "I". No fragments stacked with periods. Spell out anything a student would have to look up (iRAT gets its full name once). Cite research on the slide in plain words ("Freeman and colleagues, 2014") and keep the exact citations for the sources slide at the end. Frame evidence around what this approach adds, never around what other formats get wrong.

PRESENTING

Controls that are the same in every deck

KEY	DOES
→ / Space / click	Opens the next box; when all are open, advances the slide
←	Closes an open box, then goes back a slide
A	Marks every box on the slide as seen (skip ahead)
Esc	Closes a zoomed box; press again to leave present mode
T	Shows or hides the clock on any slide
Enter	Starts and pauses the clock
+ / -	Adds or removes 30 seconds, even while running
0	Resets the clock (drag the clock face to move it)
Q	Shows or hides the corner survey QR (intro deck only)

Activity slides preload their own time from `data-timer`. Digits turn gold in the last 30 seconds and read "Pencils down" at zero. Add `?present` to the URL to open straight into present mode. The red controls at the bottom center do the same jobs by mouse.

ACCESSIBILITY

The checks before you publish

Text on white is navy or muted, never gold. Text on navy is white or light, never muted. Every image (a QR code, a diagram) has an `alt`. Every box is a real button to a screen reader, and Enter or Space opens it from the keyboard. Unopened boxes dim only slightly, so they stay readable. If you add a new color pairing, check it: normal text needs 4.5:1, and every pair in the table above clears 7:1.

DO NOT

A short list

No paragraphs as the visible content of a box (that is what the small sentence is for). No more than four boxes per slide. No slide without a takeaway line. No paid slide tools, no exported PowerPoints for students. No student names, scores, or anything personal in a deck, since decks are public files.